



OPEN SOURCE CODING ASSIGNMENT PART 1

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L&L Budget Research Project

1. Introduction

In today's digital age, effective financial management is crucial for individuals. The prevalence of smartphones and digital financial tools has spawned personal budgeting apps that help users organize their income, monitor spending, and reach financial objectives (Investopedia, 2024).

These apps offer convenient, user-friendly, and efficient resources for enhancing financial literacy and encouraging responsible spending habits (Google, 2026). Designed to streamline the financial management process, personal budgeting applications include functions like expense tracking, budget planning, financial reporting, and savings goal monitoring. Given the multitude of options on the Android platform, users can choose tools that align with their specific financial needs and preferences.

This study centers on three popular Android budgeting apps: Goodbudget Planner, Monefy: Money Tracker, and Money Manager Expense & Budget (Goodbudget, 2026; Monefy, 2026; Money Manager, 2026). These apps were chosen due to their popularity, functionality, and varied methods of financial management. The aim of this report is to evaluate each application based on their features, advantages, disadvantages, and innovative aspects. Additionally, the report seeks to pinpoint the most effective elements that could be integrated into a new budgeting app.

2. Research on Each Application

2.1 Goodbudget Planner

a. Overview of the Application

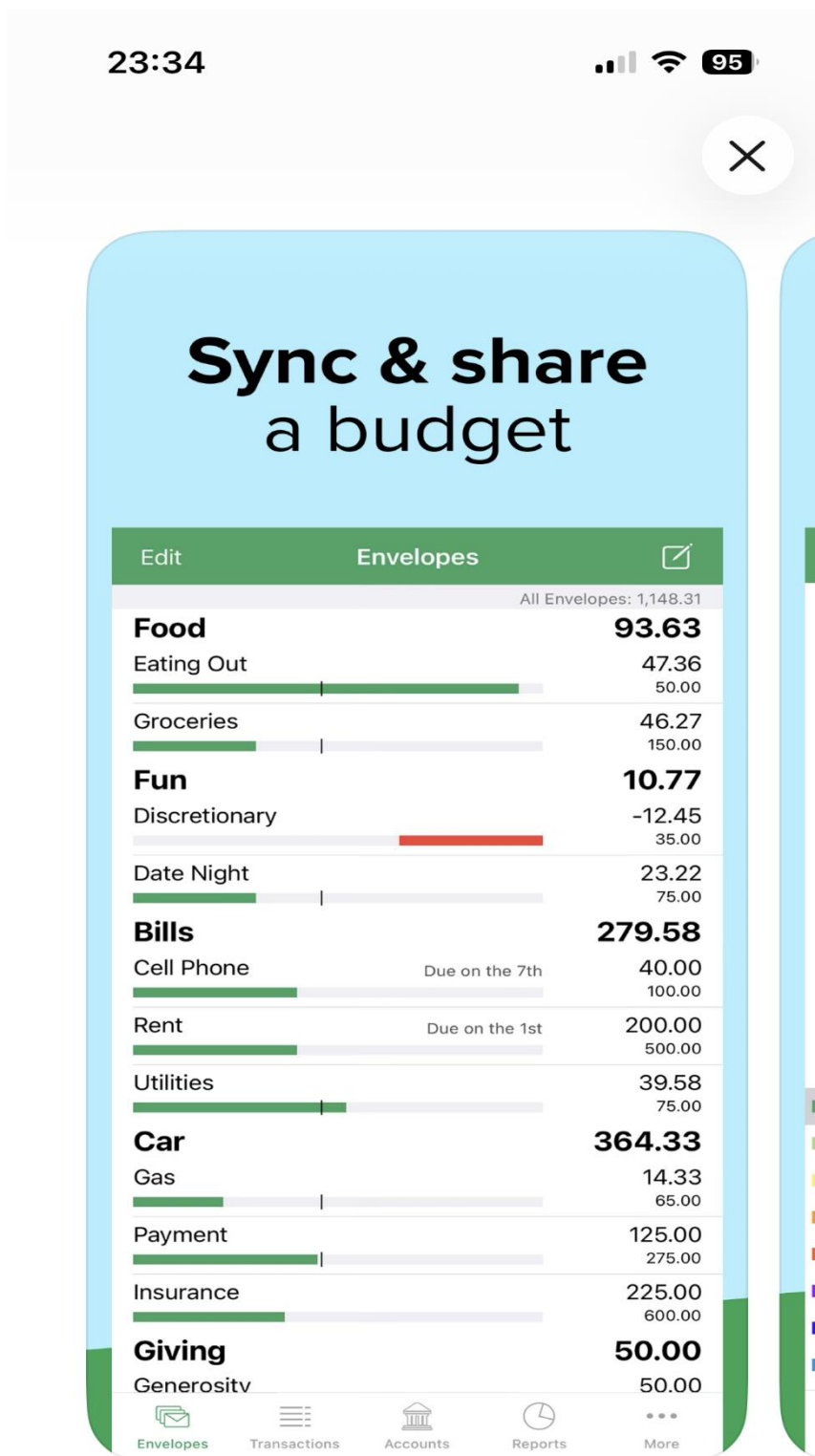
Goodbudget Planner utilizes the envelope budgeting method, in which users allocate portions of their income into designated categories, or "envelopes," like groceries, rent, transportation, and savings (Goodbudget, 2026). This app promotes proactive spending planning rather than just tracking past expenditures.

Notably, Goodbudget allows data synchronization across multiple devices, making it ideal for families or partners who share financial responsibilities. It also generates financial reports to help users track their spending habits over time (Goodbudget, 2026).

Suggested Screenshots:

- Main dashboard displaying envelope categories
- Financial reports showing income and expenses
- Transaction entry interface

Figure 1: Goodbudget Envelope Dashboard



b. Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths: Goodbudget encourages disciplined financial planning by prompting users to allocate funds before spending (Goodbudget, 2026). Its envelope system is effective for controlling overspending and prioritizing necessary expenses. Data synchronization across devices enhances collaborative budgeting, and the app provides well-organized financial reports.

Weaknesses: However, Goodbudget requires manual transaction entry, which can be tedious for some users. The free version offers limited features, and users may need to upgrade to access the full range of functionalities. Additionally, the app does not support automatic integration with bank accounts (Goodbudget, 2026).

c. Innovative Features

One of Goodbudget's main innovations is its digital adaptation of the traditional envelope budgeting approach, fostering proactive financial planning (Goodbudget, 2026). The multi-device synchronization allows for efficient management of shared budgets, and the app includes tools for goal-setting to aid users in achieving their financial targets.

2.2 Monefy: Money Tracker.

Overview of the Application

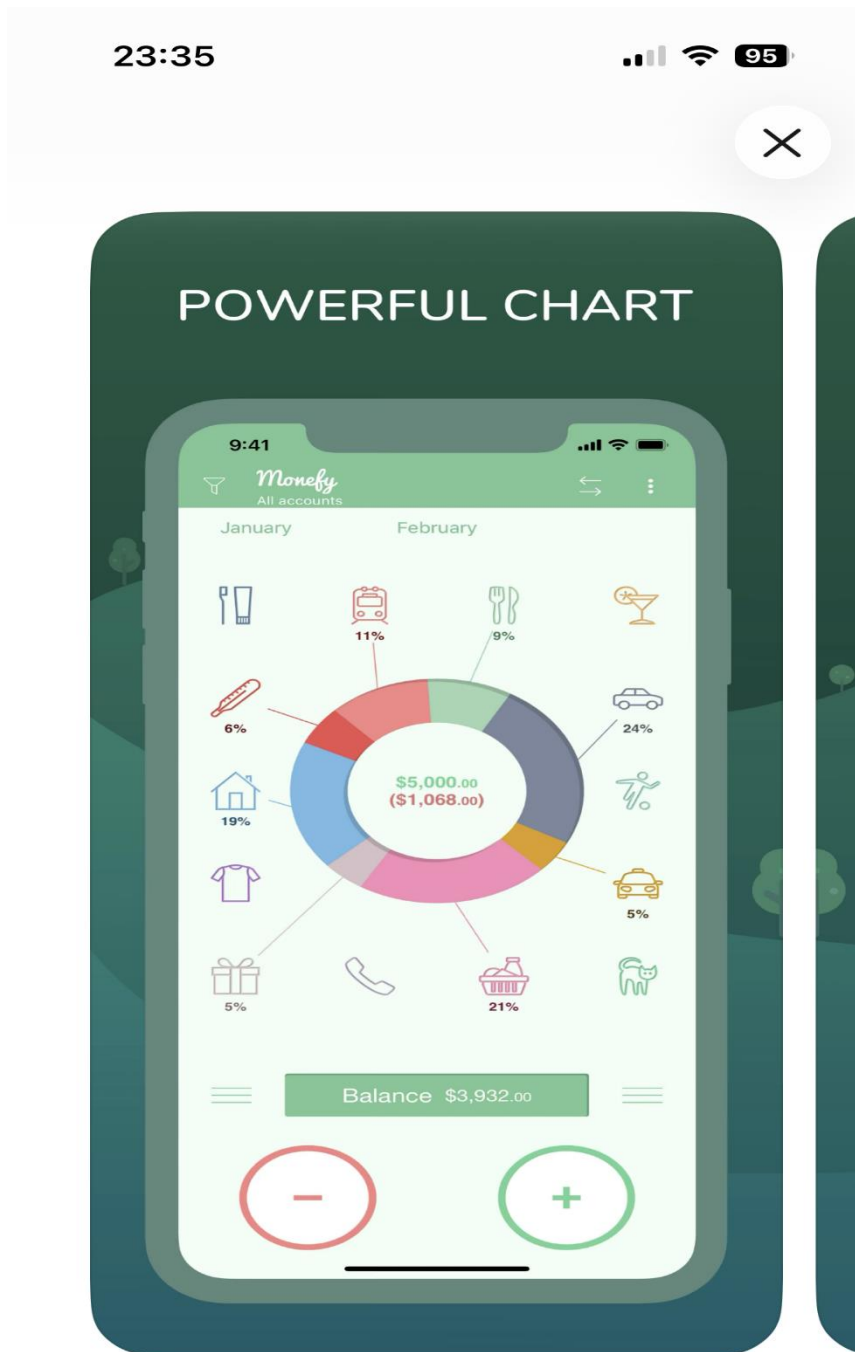
Monefy: Money Tracker is a straightforward budgeting app designed for quick and efficient expense tracking. It enables users to log expenses with minimal effort, often requiring just a single tap, making it particularly attractive to beginners (Monefy, 2026).

Monefy emphasizes visual representations, employing charts and graphs to present financial data, enabling users to easily understand their spending behaviors and pinpoint areas needing adjustments (Monefy, 2026).

Suggested Screenshots:

- Pie chart displaying expense distribution
- Expense entry screen
- Monthly financial summary

Figure 2: Monefy Expense Pie Chart



b. Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths: Monefy is extremely user-friendly, allowing for rapid transaction logging (Monefy, 2026). Its visually engaging charts facilitate the interpretation of financial

data, and it supports multiple currencies, catering to users who travel frequently or engage in international transactions.

Weaknesses: On the downside, Monefy lacks advanced budgeting features, such as detailed financial planning tools and automated bank integration (Monefy, 2026).

c. Innovative Features

The standout innovation of Monefy is its one-click expense entry feature, greatly enhancing usability and efficiency (Monefy, 2026). The app also provides real-time visual charts that deliver immediate feedback on spending habits, along with cloud backup options that ensure user data remains secure and available.

2.3 Money Manager Expense & Budget

a. Overview of the Application

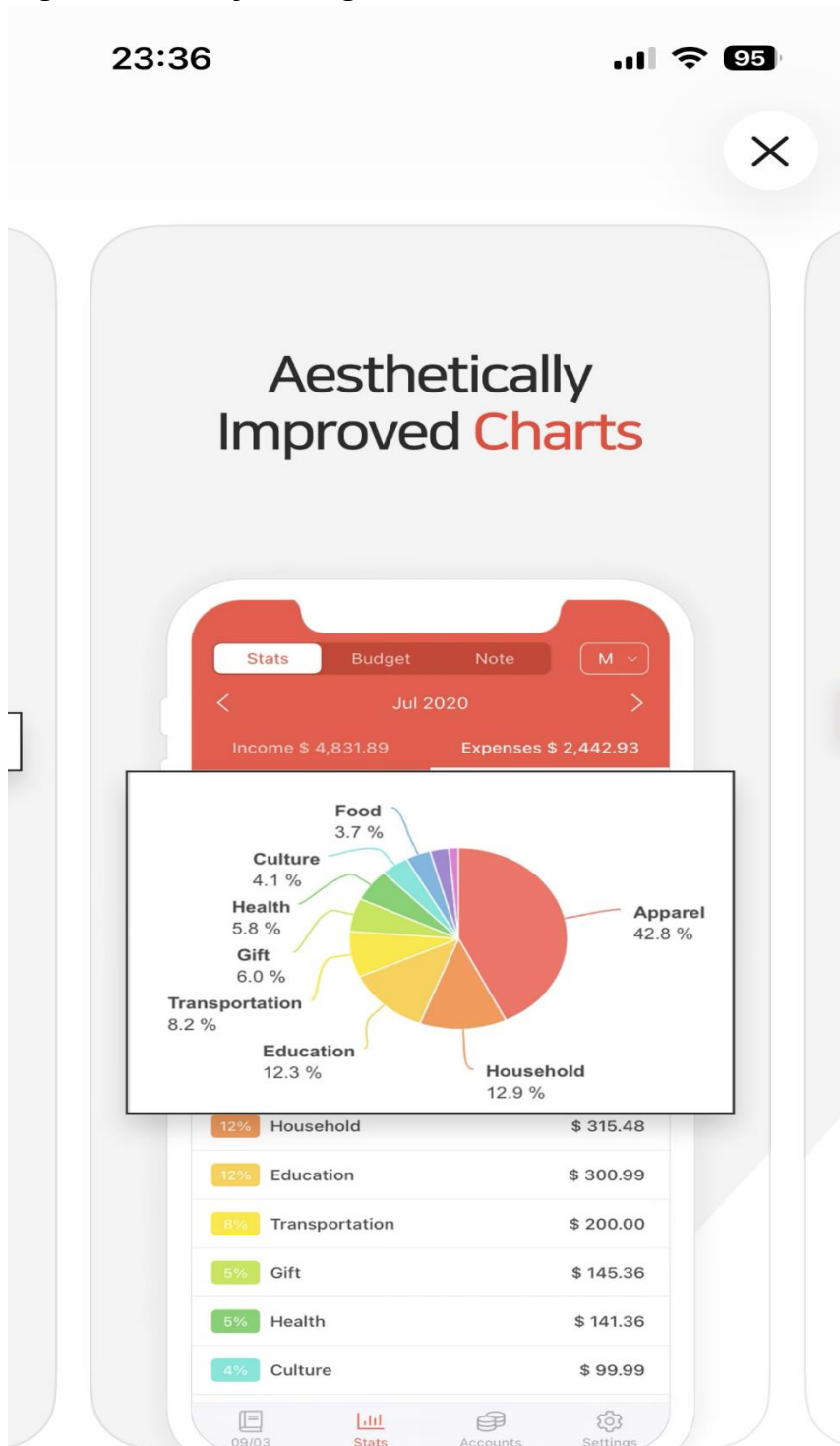
Money Manager Expense & Budget is a robust financial management tool that combines expense tracking, budgeting, and financial analysis (Money Manager, 2026). Unlike simpler applications, it includes advanced features such as a double-entry bookkeeping system typically used in professional accounting.

The app provides users with extensive reports, graphs, and statistics for a deeper understanding of their financial behavior and supports the management of multiple accounts, including bank accounts, credit cards, and cash balances (Money Manager, 2026).

Suggested Screenshots:

- Financial dashboard with graphs
- Transaction history screen
- Asset and account management interface

Figure 3: Money Manager Financial Dashboard



b. Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths: Money Manager excels in advanced financial tracking capabilities, making it suitable for users needing in-depth analysis (Money Manager, 2026). With comprehensive reports and the ability to manage multiple accounts in one location, it also includes backup and export functions, enhancing data security.

Weaknesses: The application's complexity may be daunting for beginners, and its interface isn't as intuitive as simpler apps like Monefy. Additionally, some advanced features are only available in the premium version (Money Manager, 2026).

c. Innovative Features

A key innovation of Money Manager is its double-entry bookkeeping system, providing accurate and detailed financial tracking (Money Manager, 2026).

3. Visual Comparison of Applications

Feature	Goodbudget	Monefy	Money Manager
Ease of Use	Moderate	Very Easy	Moderate
Budgeting Approach	Envelope System	Basic Tracking	Advanced Budgeting
Visual Reports	Good	Excellent	Detailed
Synchronisation	Yes	Yes	Limited

Feature	Goodbudget	Monefy	Money Manager
Suitable Users	Families	Beginners	Advanced Users

(Goodbudget, 2026; Monefy, 2026; Money Manager, 2026).

4. Best Features to Include in a New Application

Through the examination of these three applications, several standout features should be considered for a new budgeting app:

- The envelope budgeting system from Goodbudget (Goodbudget, 2026)
- The one-click expense entry from Monefy (Monefy, 2026), improving usability and efficiency.
- Visual charts and graphs from both Monefy and Money Manager (Monefy, 2026; Money Manager, 2026), enhancing user understanding of finances.

- Advanced reporting and analytics from Money Manager (Money Manager, 2026) for deeper insights.
- Multi-device synchronization (Goodbudget, 2026; Monefy, 2026)
- Backup and export functionality (Money Manager, 2026)
- Goal-setting and savings tracking features (Goodbudget, 2026)

Incorporating these elements would lead to the creation of a comprehensive and user-friendly budgeting application.

5. Conclusion

In summary, personal budgeting applications are vital tools for effective financial management (Investopedia, 2024). Each of the three apps evaluated in this report presents unique strengths: Goodbudget is adept at structured budgeting and collaborative finance management, Monefy excels in simplicity, and Money Manager offers advanced functionalities for in-depth financial analysis (Goodbudget, 2026; Monefy, 2026; Money Manager, 2026).

Despite their various limitations, their strengths highlight essential components for an effective budgeting tool. By blending the best features from these applications, it is feasible to create a versatile and user-friendly budgeting app that meets diverse user needs.

Reference List

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